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VIA EMAIL SUBMISSION

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RE: Vehicle Grid Integration Council Comments on The Massachusetts Department of Energy Resources Report and Policy Recommendations Peak Potential: Reducing energy costs and empowering consumers with load management and virtual power plants

The Vehicle-Grid Integration Council (VGIC) is a 501(c)(6) membership-based advocacy organization committed to advancing the role of vehicle-grid integration (VGI) through policy development, education, outreach, and research. VGIC supports the transition to decarbonized transportation and electric sectors by ensuring that the value of flexible EV charging and discharging is recognized and compensated to support a more reliable, affordable, and efficient electric grid.

VGIC commends the Massachusetts Department of Energy Resources (DOER) for publishing *Peak Potential: Reducing Energy Costs and Empowering Consumers with Load Management and Virtual Power Plants*. The report provides a clear, analytically rigorous framework for understanding how load management can reduce peak demand, control long-term system costs, and improve energy affordability as Massachusetts electrifies transportation and buildings and more broadly seeks to achieve its climate goals.

VGIC strongly supports the report's conclusion that electric vehicles, and **vehicle-grid integration (VGI) solutions in particular (encompassing both managed and bidirectional charging), represent the single most significant source of future grid flexibility in the Commonwealth.** The report explicitly finds that EV managed charging and bidirectional charging are not speculative resources, but rather no-regrets strategies with material near- and long-term value:

> "EV load management, through both managed charging programs and vehicle-to-everything (V2X), is a **no-regrets, high-potential strategy that could provide 300 MW of capacity in the near term and 6.5 GW in the long term**." (Peak Potential Report, p. 3; emphasis added)

The report further identifies EVs as "the single biggest source of load flexibility" across all modeled years, noting that managed charging provides immediate, low-cost benefits, while V2X more than doubles peak reduction capability per vehicle as bidirectional charging system deployments accelerate (Peak Potential Report, pp. 16–17).

These findings are consistent with conclusions reached in other major grid flexibility studies. For example, New York State's *Grid Flexibility Potential Study* identifies electric vehicles as one of the largest and most scalable sources of grid flexibility, with managed charging delivering near-term system value and bidirectional EVs providing dispatchable capacity in the medium term. The study finds that New York's total grid flexibility potential exceeds 8 GW by 2040, equivalent to roughly 25% of net system peak demand, and that EVs (both managed and bidirectional charging) account for the largest share of this total.[1]

At the national level, the U.S. Department of Energy's *Pathways to Commercial Liftoff: Virtual Power Plants* report similarly identifies electric vehicles as a dominant and fast-growing source of grid flexibility within future VPP portfolios. The DOE finds that EV charging infrastructure and EV batteries together already represent tens of gigawatts of nameplate flexible demand and storage potential, and that EV-related capacity is growing faster than any other distributed energy resource. The report further concludes that managed EV charging alone can shift 70% or more of peak-period charging demand for participating customers, reinforcing EVs as a scalable, low-cost flexibility resource today. While the report notes that vehicle-to-grid deployment remains limited in the residential sector, significant advancements in the residential bidirectional charging sector have occurred since the publication of this report, including the launch of large-scale initiatives in California, Connecticut, and Massachusetts and new offerings from Kia, Ford, GM, Tesla, Volvo, Polestar, and Nissan. Commercial fleets, meanwhile, remain an exciting V2X use

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[1] See Brattle Group, January 2025, New York's Grid Flexibility Potential VOLUME I: SUMMARY REPORT available at https://www.brattle.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/New-Yorks-Grid-Flexibility-Potential-Volume-I-Summary-Report.pdf.

case. The report identifies bidirectional EV integration as a priority area for continued analysis and market development as VPPs scale nationally.[2]

Taken together, the findings in Peak Potential align closely with VGIC's understanding and our ongoing regulatory and policy work across jurisdictions. VGIC seeks to ensure EVs are treated as grid-interactive infrastructure, not merely incremental load, and we are available to work with regulators, utilities, and policymakers to unlock the full potential of EVs as flexible grid resources. VGIC further supports the establishment of explicit regulatory pathways for bidirectional charging, including clear interconnection, export, and compensation rules, to allow V2X resources to move beyond pilot programs and participate meaningfully in grid planning and operations.

VGIC recommends that the DOER, Department of Public Utilities, and stakeholders across the Commonwealth translate the *Peak Potential* findings into durable policies and programs that deliver customer value, grid reliability, and long-term cost savings for all ratepayers. VGIC is available to consider specific recommendations and looks forward to collaborating with the DOER, the Department of Public Utilities, and other key stakeholders across the Commonwealth on this important initiative.

Respectfully submitted,

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[2] See U.S. Department of Energy, January 2025, Pathways to Commercial Liftoff: Virtual Power Plants 2025 Update available at https://www.smartenergydecisions.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/liftoff_doe_virtualpowerplants2025update.pdf